

What Are You Proving?

Hamza Afzal · 2026-10-09

Personalized proof statement. Name, field, audience, and action were supplied/confirmed by Hamza in this conversation. The assistant helped narrow the wording to one concrete API engineering claim. Hamza should read it aloud and change any phrasing he cannot stand behind.

One-paragraph proof statement

I am Hamza Afzal, focusing on backend development and engineering. I can build a tested backend API that converts anonymized search signals into explainable content-review priorities. I am building this proof for a backend engineering lead evaluating my backend project, so they can invite me to an interview about this backend project. The API contract, input validation, automated checks, and runnable example provide the evidence; any results from the starter dataset demonstrate a prototype rather than production readiness.

One-line why

A CV can name backend engineering; an owned portfolio can let someone inspect the API contract, run an example, and examine the checks that support that claim.

Narrowing choices and actual interview status

Element	Choice	Evidence/status
Primary skill	Backend development and engineering, demonstrated through one tested API	Hamza supplied the field in this conversation
Specific proof	Tested API that converts safe search-signal inputs into explained review priorities	Actual local backend at <code>work/backend_api/</code> ; synthetic request examples and passing HTTP checks are recorded
One person	A backend engineering lead	Confirmed by Hamza
One action	Invite Hamza to an interview about this backend project	Confirmed by Hamza

The assistant asked for identity, skill, audience/action, recurring weekly tasks, and GitHub/contact. Hamza supplied: Hamza Afzal; Backend Development and Engineering; a backend engineering lead; invite me to an interview; coding/debugging/planning/designing, followed by explicit confirmation of the 12 audit tasks; GitHub Hamza2-2. This records actual known inputs without inventing a longer interview transcript.

Reflection still needed: What can Hamza explain and modify himself after the AI-assisted build? Which detail would he remove because it overstates his current ability? The audience and action have already been answered.

Claim boundary

The actual local API has a schema at `work/backend_api/openapi.json`, executable examples in its README, and passing real-HTTP check output at `work/backend_api/TEST_RESULTS.txt`. Its demo requests are synthetic, its queue uses a documented fixed rule, and learned-model metrics come from a separate notebook. The portfolio must not say the API is deployed in production, improves client search traffic, or proves warehouse results. AI assistance is disclosed; Hamza's review and explanation are part of the proof.